MODULE 00 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Claude Certified Architect – Professional: The Complete Course

An exam-focused course built from Anthropic's own documentation: seven domains, 309 original questions, three full-length practice papers, and every recent change dated.

COURSE 39 videos LENGTH About 8 h 30 min QUESTIONS 309 original

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Most AI demos work. Many AI systems still fail in production. This exam tests whether you can tell the difference, and design for it.

The exam in one slide

Who can sit it	People at Claude Partner Network organisations, aged 18 or over
The paper	63 items in 120 minutes; multiple choice and multiple response
Pass mark	Scaled 720, on a scale of 100 to 1,000
Delivery	Online proctored, or at a Pearson VUE test centre; USD 175
Validity	12 months; on-time renewal is a free, unproctored assessment

GOOD TO KNOW

Recommended experience is not a prerequisite. Only your result counts.

Seven domains, and the time this course gives each

DOMAIN	EXAM WEIGHT	THIS COURSE
D1 Solution design and architecture	17%	67.5 min
D2 Models, prompting and context	13%	50.3 min
D3 Integration	19%	77.0 min
D4 Evaluation, testing and optimisation	16%	57.9 min
D5 Governance, safety and risk	14%	49.4 min
D6 Stakeholders and lifecycle	14%	51.8 min
D7 Developer productivity	7%	26.6 min

THE TIEBREAKER

Course time follows the official weights, not a practice bank. Design and integration carry over a third of the marks.

A warning about practice banks

- **Banks are skewed** towards easy-to-write topics: Claude Code scopes, documentation, governance.
- **The bank analysed for this course** gave developer productivity 19%; the guide gives it 7%.
- **It gave design 7%;** the guide gives it 17%.
- **This course used the bank only** to see which decisions get tested. No bank question is reused.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Prepare to the official weights. A bank-shaped study plan over-prepares the smallest domain.

How this course was built

- **Facts from Anthropic's documentation,** checked on 12 and 13 October 2026, with dates on screen.
- **309 original questions:** 246 worked scenarios, and 63 practice-paper questions.
- **Labelled honestly:** working definitions where Anthropic gives none, course guidance marked as such.
- **Balanced answers:** no letter favoured, and option length gives nothing away.
- **A fictional running example,** so every decision has real constraints.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Where Anthropic's own pages disagree, the course says so, and does not test the disputed detail.

The platform has moved since the guide

- **New models** from July to October 2026, including the 5.5 family and Fable 5.1.
- **Current models reject** forced tool choice, sampling tweaks and manual thinking budgets.
- **A new MCP specification** on 28 July 2026, stateless by design.
- **Claude Code** starts in auto mode; **Claude for Government** is available.
- **Usage Policy update** effective 12 November 2026.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Answer with the principle; treat version details as a currency check. Module 34 has every change, dated.

What the exam rewards

- **Constraints first:** regulation, data boundaries, SLAs and budgets rule options out.
- **The simplest design that works:** a workflow before an agent, one agent before many.
- **Least privilege:** remove what is not needed, enforce in code, not in prompts.
- **Evidence before change:** define good, measure, change one thing, re-measure.
- **People where the harm is real,** with the authority to change the outcome.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Nearly every question turns on one of these five habits.

Question shapes you will meet

SHAPE	WHAT TO DO
One best answer from four	Strike what breaks a constraint, then apply the qualifier
Choose two: part of the solution	The two picks combine into one fix
Choose two: a complete solution	Each pick works on its own
Which steps come BEFORE X	Find the step that defines good; it comes first

GOOD TO KNOW

Shares come from this course's own analysis of a practice bank: about half single answer, two in five choose two, one in ten ordering.

Meet Corvane Partners, your employer in this course

CLIENT	WHAT MAKES IT HARD
Mereside Mutual, a UK building society	UK GDPR, a financial regulator, UK or EU processing on Bedrock
Quillon Health, a US health network	HIPAA, clinical risk, a strict portal SLA
Tallyhawk, a software company	Tool-heavy agents, Claude Code across 18 teams

THE RUNNING EXAMPLE

All three clients are fictional. Their constraints are the kind the exam builds questions from.

How every module works

- **Teaching slides,** each with an exam signal in the box at the bottom.
- **Worked scenarios:** when you hear "Pause now, and decide", pause and commit.
- **"Choose two":** read whether the picks combine, or each stands alone.
- **The worked answer** explains why every wrong option fails.
- **"In five lines"** closes each module.

> ON THE EXAM
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> Watching an answer you never committed to feels like learning. Mostly, it is not.

The course map: teaching

PART	MODULES	LENGTH
D1 Solution design and architecture	02-06	67.5 min
D2 Models, prompting and context	07-10	50.3 min
D3 Integration	11-16	77.0 min
D4 Evaluation, testing and optimisation	17-21	57.9 min
D5 Governance, safety and risk	22-25	49.4 min
D6 Stakeholders and lifecycle	26-29	51.8 min
D7 Developer productivity	30-31	26.6 min

THE MAP

Teaching across the seven domains: 380 minutes.

The course map: strategy and practice

PART	MODULES	LENGTH
Introduction and the architect	00-01	15.8 min plus this video
Exam strategy: sequences, confusion pairs, changes, question craft	32-35	47.7 min
Practice papers: 63 questions, a full sitting	36-38	60.0 min
Whole course, modules 01-38		504.0 min (8 h 24 min)

THE MAP

Sit the three papers last, timed, as one full exam.

Choose your route

IF YOU ARE	WATCH
New to this exam	Everything, in order; papers last, timed
Short of time	01, then 32-35, then the papers; re-watch weak domains
An experienced Claude architect	34 and 33 first, then a paper; fill the gaps it shows
Re-sitting or renewing	34, then the papers; domains where you score under 60%

THE TIEBREAKER

Whatever the route, sit at least one full paper against the clock before the exam.

In five lines

- **63 items, 120 minutes,** scaled 720 to pass; open to Claude Partner Network organisations.
- **Study to the official weights,** not a practice bank's.
- **Every fact checked and dated;** every question original.
- **Pause and commit** at every scenario; study the wrong answers.
- **Sit the three papers last,** timed, as one full exam.

> COMING UP
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> Next: module 01, the professional architect.